

The Shepherd's Little Lambs

Everything the leaders and helpers need to rehearse and run the skit: who does what, where everyone stands, the narrator's script, the children's lines, a rehearsal plan, and the run sheet for the day. About 6 minutes on stage.

1 · Roles: who does what

ROLE	WHO	THEIR JOB
Shepherd	The leader or a confident helper	On stage the whole time. Leads the lambs, counts them, finds the lost lamb, stands beside each child who speaks. Quietly prompts the children with gestures.
Narrator	A helper with a clear voice	Stands at the front corner with the script (section 3). Reads the story, starts each scene, and says any forgotten line <i>with</i> the child.
Lamb wrangler	A helper, crouched at the side, off stage	Calms nerves, fixes headbands, steers a wanderer back, holds a child who won't go on. Hands the lost lamb its cue to tiptoe off.
Sound helper	Anyone with the laptop or phone	Plays the song track at the finale (or signals the pianist). Plays nothing during the scenes.
Lion (optional)	A playful helper or older sibling	Enters only in Scene 4. Soft, silly roar, slow moves, smiling. Exits the moment the Shepherd taps the staff.
Lambs	Every child	Baa, follow the Shepherd, say one line, count, sing with actions.
Lost lamb	One confident child	Tiptoes behind the bush in Scene 3 and gives the tiny "baa". Choose in April; keep a second child ready as backup.

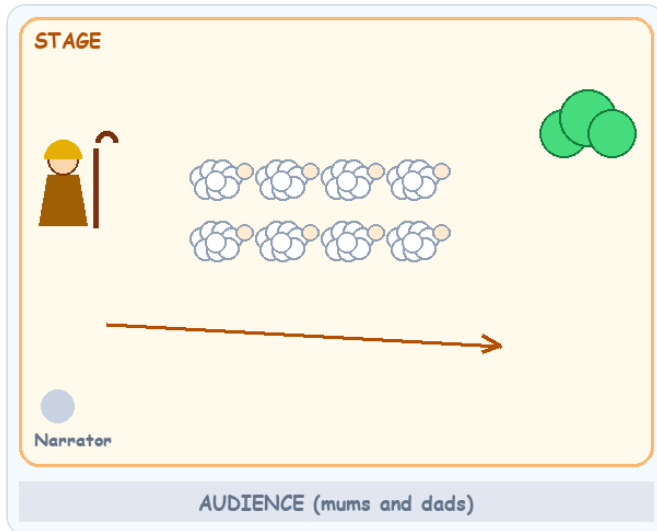
Props and set

- **The bush:** a chair with a green sheet over it, at the far side of the stage. The lost lamb must be able to crouch behind it, out of sight.
- **Hills:** a blanket over a low bench or cushions. **Water:** a blue cloth on the floor.
- **Floor marks:** one strip of coloured tape per child for the Scene 2 row and the finale row (the same row). Write each child's initial on their tape.
- **Shepherd:** robe, headscarf, staff (patterns in [headgear-patterns.pdf](#)).

2 · Scenes and stage maps

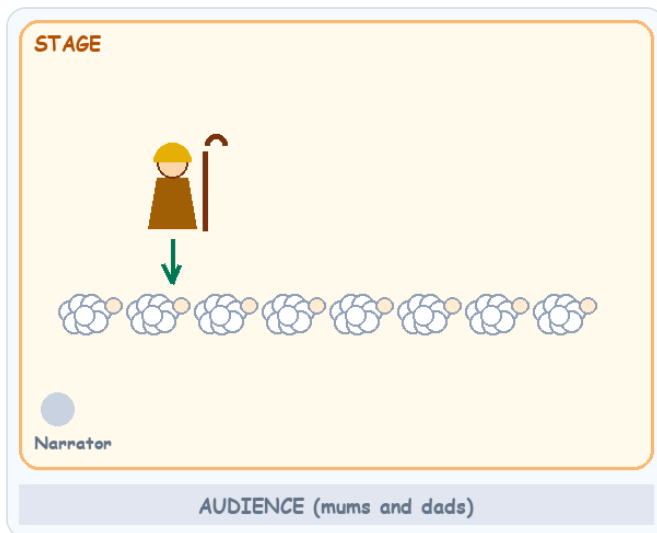
The audience sits at the bottom of each map. The pink lamb is the lost lamb. Keep the children **facing the audience** whenever they speak or sing.

Scene 1 · Wake up, little lambs (*about 1 min*)



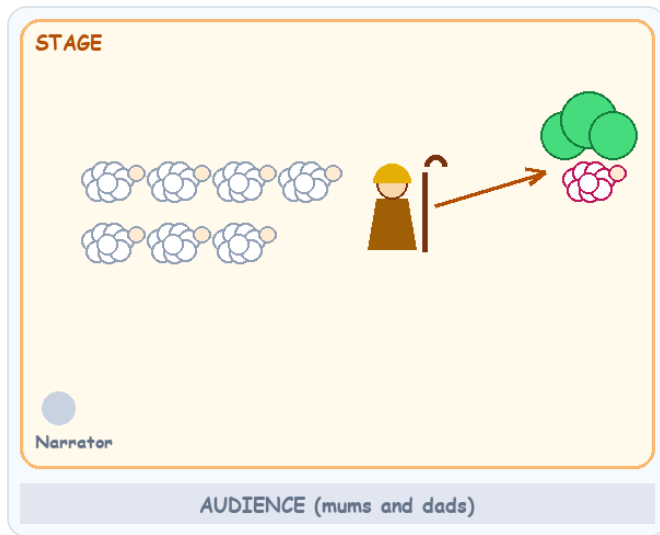
- **Start:** the lambs are curled up asleep in a group, centre stage, before the audience is quiet.
- The Shepherd walks in from the side and teaches the audience their part: "BAA!"
- "Come, little lambs!" → everyone baas → lambs stretch, stand, and follow the Shepherd once round the stage in a line, ending in the Scene 2 row.
- **Watch for:** the line bunching up. The Shepherd walks slowly, looking back.

Scene 2 · What my Shepherd gives me (*about 1½ min*)



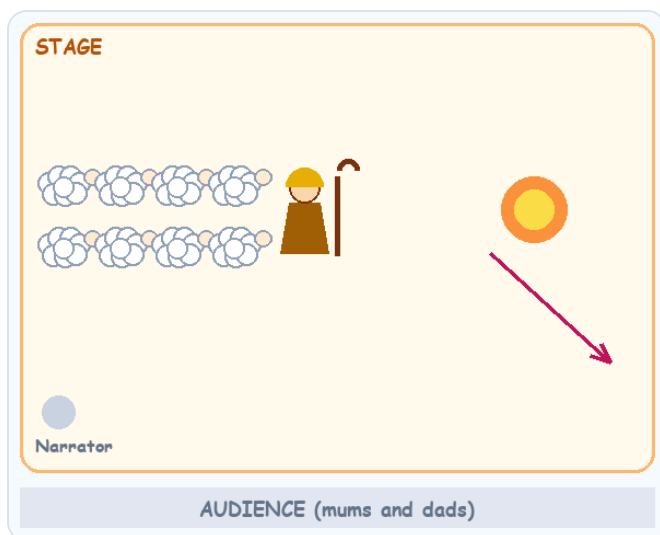
- Lambs sit on their tape marks in one row, facing the audience.
- The Shepherd walks along the row and stands beside each child in turn. The child stands, says their line **loudly, to the mums and dads**, and sits.
- All stand for the last line together: "Jesus is my Shepherd!"
- **Watch for:** mumbling to the floor. Practise "chin up, look at the back wall".

Scene 3 · One is missing! (*about 1½ min*)



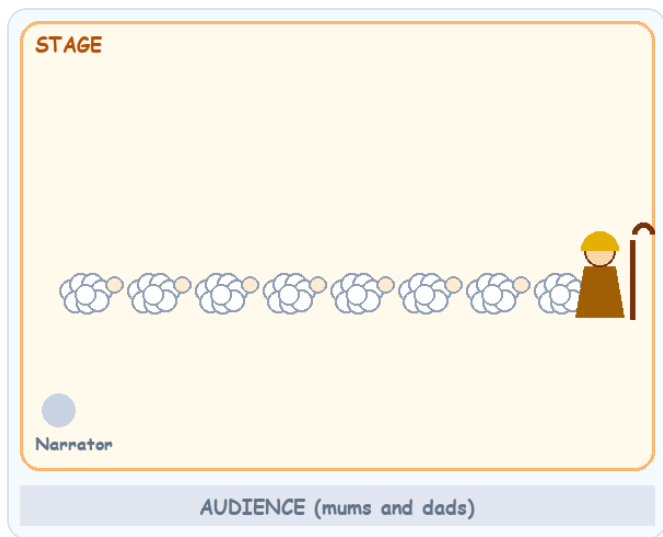
- On the Narrator's "butterfly" line, the lost lamb tiptoes behind the bush. The wrangler can give a small nod as the cue.
- The Shepherd counts, touching each head; everyone counts aloud. Hands on cheeks: "ONE IS MISSING!"
- The Shepherd searches: the hills, the water, asks the audience. Then a tiny "baa..." from the bush.
- Found! Big hug, walk back holding hands. All: "HOORAY!"
- **Watch for:** the lost lamb popping out too early. Tell them: "Stay hidden until the Shepherd says your name."

Scene 4 • The lion *(optional, about 1 min)*



- The Lion creeps in from the far side with a soft, silly roar.
- The lambs huddle behind the Shepherd. "Go away, lion! These are MY lambs!" Staff tap. The Lion runs off.
- All: "Our Shepherd keeps us safe!"
- **Skip it** if any child is scared in rehearsal, or if the program runs long.

Scene 5 • Finale *(about 1 min)*



- Lambs stand on their tape marks in one row. The Shepherd stands at the end.
- All: "The Lord is my shepherd. He gives me everything I need."
- The song starts: "Jesus Is My Shepherd" with the actions. Arms up high on the last line.
- Bow, one big "BAA!", and walk off following the Shepherd.

3 · Narrator script

Print this page for the Narrator. Grey lines are stage directions, not read aloud. Pause after every line so the children can act.

Lambs curled up asleep, centre stage. Wait for quiet.

NARRATOR: Once upon a time, a shepherd had a flock of little lambs. Every morning, he came to wake them up.

Shepherd walks in.

SHEPHERD (to audience): Mums and dads, when I say "Come, little lambs!", you help my lambs and say BAA! Let's practise... Come, little lambs!

AUDIENCE: BAA!

SHEPHERD: Come, little lambs! **LAMBS + AUDIENCE:** BAA!

Lambs stand and follow the Shepherd round the stage, then sit on their tape marks.

NARRATOR: The shepherd took his lambs to green grass and cool water. The lambs were happy. Listen to what they say.

Each child stands, says their line, sits. The Shepherd stands beside each one.

ALL LAMBS (standing): Jesus is my Shepherd!

NARRATOR: But one little lamb saw a butterfly... and followed it far, far away.

Lost lamb tiptoes behind the bush.

NARRATOR: At night, the shepherd counted his lambs.

SHEPHERD: Let's count them. Help me, lambs! *(everyone counts aloud)*

ALL LAMBS (hands on cheeks): ONE IS MISSING!

SHEPHERD: I will find my lost lamb! ... *(searching)* Have you seen my lamb?

LOST LAMB (small voice): Baa...

Shepherd finds the lamb, hugs, walks back holding hands.

ALL LAMBS: HOORAY!

— Scene 4, only if you're doing it —

NARRATOR: One night, a lion came...

Lion creeps in, soft roar. Lambs huddle behind the Shepherd.

SHEPHERD: Go away, lion! These are MY lambs! *(staff tap; Lion runs off)*

ALL LAMBS: Our Shepherd keeps us safe!

— *Finale* —

NARRATOR: A good shepherd looks after his lambs. And Jesus is OUR Good Shepherd.

Lambs stand on their marks in one row.

ALL: The Lord is my shepherd. He gives me everything I need.

Song starts: "Jesus Is My Shepherd" with actions. Bow.

ALL LAMBS: BAA!

4 · Line cards for Scene 2

One line per child. Cut out, write the child's name on the back, and send it home in January so parents can practise. Short lines go to the youngest or shyest children.

"He gives me green grass!"

Action: pretend to munch grass

"He gives me cool water!"

Action: cup your hands and sip

"He keeps me safe!"

Action: hug yourself

"He knows my name!"

Action: point to yourself

"He gives me food!"

Action: rub your tummy

"He gives me my family!"

Action: arms wide open

"He carries me!"

Action: rock a baby in your arms

"He is always with me!"

Action: hold a friend's hand

"He finds me when I'm lost!"

Action: hand over your eyes, looking

"He loves me!"

Action: hands on your heart

"He leads me home!"

Spare line, for an 11th child

"He never leaves me!"

Spare line, for a 12th child

5 · Rehearsal plan

Each rehearsal is **5 minutes inside a normal meeting**, unless marked. Stop while they're still enjoying it.

WHEN	WHAT TO DO	THEY'RE READY WHEN...
Oct–Dec every meeting	Song at Good-baa. Play "Come, little lambs!" → "BAA!" as a game (Scene 1). Play Find the Lost Lamb and Count the Flock as games (Scene 3). Don't call it a skit yet.	They sing the song and do the actions without you leading
January, week 1	Tell them: "We're going to do a play for the mums and dads!" Show the skit walkthrough video. Hand out line cards to take home.	Every child knows which line is theirs
Jan–Feb weekly	Practise Scene 2 only: sit in a row, stand, say your line to the back wall, sit. Make the lamb headbands (one 15-min craft).	Every child says their line with only a small prompt
March, week 1	Put down the tape marks. Walk through Scenes 1–2–3 slowly, no costumes. Shepherd and Narrator read from the script.	Children know where to sit and stand
March weekly	One scene per week, then the finale. Add Scene 4 only if no one is scared.	Each scene runs without stopping
April once	First full run, in headbands. Choose the lost lamb (and a backup). Time it.	The skit runs start to end in about 6 min
May 2 sessions, 15 min	Dress rehearsals in the real room, full costume, with the sound helper. Film one and send it to parents.	Smooth enough to enjoy. Perfect is not the goal

6 · Coaching 4- and 5-year-olds

What works

- **Show, don't explain.** Do the move; they copy.
- **Say lines *with* them** the first few times, then mouth them, then just nod.
- **Tape marks** beat any instruction about where to stand.
- **Praise out loud and specifically:** "Lily, I heard every word!"
- **Keep it a game.** "Can the lambs be quieter than mice?"

When something goes wrong

- **Shy child:** they stand next to the Shepherd, or say the line with a buddy. Some will only baa, and that's fine.
- **Forgot the line:** the Narrator says it with them. Never stop the skit.
- **Crying or won't go on:** the wrangler holds them at the side. Invite them in for the finale song only.
- **Wanderer:** the Shepherd gently takes their hand: "Stay with your shepherd, little

- **Same order every time.** Repetition is what makes them confident.

lamb!" That's in character.

- **Giggles:** let them. The audience will laugh too.
- **Missing child on the day:** a neighbour takes their line, or the Narrator reads it.

7 · On the day

Before the program

- ☐ Tape marks down on the stage
- ☐ Bush, hills and water in place
- ☐ Headbands out of the bag, each by name
- ☐ Shepherd robe, headscarf, staff
- ☐ Lion mane (if doing Scene 4)
- ☐ Laptop charged, speaker tested, song track cued
- ☐ Narrator has the printed script
- ☐ Toilet trip for every lamb 15 minutes before
- ☐ One quick practice of "Come, little lambs!" backstage

Run sheet

CUE	WHAT HAPPENS
Program leader introduces the Little Lambs	Wrangler leads the lambs in to curl up centre stage
Room quiet	Narrator: "Once upon a time..."
Scenes 1–4	About 5 min. Sound helper stands by
"...He gives me everything I need."	Sound helper starts the song track (or the pianist plays)
Last note	Bow, "BAA!", follow the Shepherd off
Off stage	Headbands back in the bag, then the investiture ceremony